

SPROLL 04

Not This Way



a mark that is not an erasure

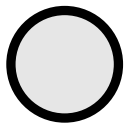
The Sproll Curriculum · Cycle I: Pops

The Sprol Curriculum

Cycle I — Pops: Things, Differences, and Counting

Sprol 04 of 40 · follows Sprol 03: Play It Again

[Illustration: a field of three shapes: circle bold and chosen, triangle plain, square with a faint line beginning to cross through it]



Sometimes you say no on purpose.

[Illustration: the square, clearly crossed out with a bold X, still fully visible beneath the mark]

 Not the square.

[Illustration: the same crossed-out square, unchanged]

 Is the square gone?

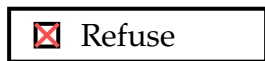
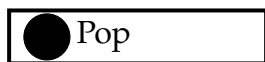
[Illustration: the crossed-out square again, with a small clarifying note: the shape underneath the X is drawn just as solidly as ever]

 **No.**

[Illustration: a small pointing hand or finger, aimed directly at the crossed-out square]

→  You can still point to it.

[Illustration: a two-line ledger strip: the first line shows a circle labeled Pop, the second line shows a crossed-out square labeled Refuse]



Both are in the record.

[Illustration: two side-by-side panels: on the left, a completely blank white space with a small question mark, labeled beneath as never chosen and never mentioned; on the right, the crossed-out square, labeled beneath as considered and refused]


never chosen,
never mentioned

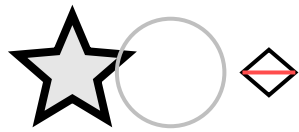

considered,
refused

These are not the same.

[Illustration: the crossed-out square once more, calm and simple, no longer needing further contrast]

 Refused is not the same as gone.

[Illustration: a completely new field: a star chosen and bold, a hexagon plain, a diamond crossed out]

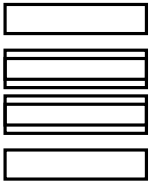


A new choice. A new refusal.

[Illustration: the star and the crossed-out diamond, sitting together, both fully visible]



[Illustration: a stack of several small ledger strips, each with one Pop line and one Refuse line, suggesting this pattern repeats]



Every choice can carry its own no.

[Illustration: the crossed-out square from the very first example, with a small question mark hovering beside it]

 Why keep something you didn't choose?

[Illustration: a circle and a crossed-out square, with a faint dotted line drawn between them, as if to ask whether they could be connected somehow]

●.....☒ Two things happened.

Could they be tied together?

— turn the page for Sproll 05: Together —

A Note for Grown-Ups

This book introduces Refuse, the second of the four primitive actions this curriculum builds from. Refusing something is not the same as never mentioning it or erasing it; it is a deliberate act, recorded just as permanently as a Pop, that marks one particular option as not chosen this time, while leaving it fully visible and nameable.

Page 9's side-by-side contrast, a blank space that was never mentioned versus a crossed-out shape that was considered and refused, is the entire point of this book stated visually. Confusing the two, treating "not chosen" as though it meant "never existed," is a genuinely easy mistake, and this book exists specifically to prevent a child from making it before the idea has a chance to solidify the wrong way.

Page 15 closes by asking whether a Pop and a Refuse could be connected to each other. That question is answered, though not resolved completely, in Sproll 05, which introduces the third primitive action, Bind.